(MAP), Bengaluru, attempts to answer through *A Moving Line: 1500 Years of Indian Visual Storytelling*.

An exhibition tracing India's visual storytelling traditions across 15 centuries, *A Moving Line...* is curated by graphic novelist Amruta Patil, and unites more than 250 works. Works, including those that went out of print, were untranslated or never entered archives, are here for the first time.

Starting with storytelling traditions such as the *kaavad*, the portable shrine carried by storytellers, and the pattachitra scroll, the show moves through Bengal's early comic strips and political cartoons to beloved characters from Amar Chitra Katha, Tinkle, Chacha Chaudhary and even the once-smuggled Phantom. It features feminist and queer narratives by contemporary creators such as the Kadak Collective, political graphic novels, web comics, augmented reality works and images created with AI.





ANGLE OF ATTACK
Bahadur: The Red Bricks House (1976) and *Lublur Prithibi* (2025)

THE SHOW MOVES **THROUGH BENGAL'S EARLY POLITICAL CARTOONS, TO AMAR CHITRA KATHA**, TO QUEER NARRATIVES

While Patil thinks technology will reshape the medium, she stresses it won't affect its core essence. "AI will undoubtedly become another tool in this ecosystem, but meaningful storytelling still comes from lived experience, imagination and cultural context."

The exhibition has been designed with tactile responses, audio guides and accompanying explanations so that more visitors can experience the artworks. ■

—Deepa Natarajan Lobo

The show is on till Nov. 15

STICK NO BILLS IS THE FIRST SOLO EXHIBITION BY ANONYMOUS INDIAN STREET ARTIST GUESSWHO



Street art is, by its very nature, succinct and subversive, often making socio-political statements that others don't dare express. While the art world may have an idea of the true identity of an Indian anonymous street artist Guesswho, the average person walking around Fort Kochi or Bengaluru's Church Street will only know them by a chuckle elicited here, a deeper ponder wrought there.

To be able to see 12 artworks all in one place is a rare opportunity. Guesswho's first solo show—*Stick No Bills*—showcases the artist's wry take on today's times, sometimes critical, sometimes playful, often sarcastic. Like the almost meta 'Street Art' with graffiti script and men 'tagging' the artist's work with their urination in public. Or the girl sticking the bill that reads 'Stick No Bills'!

Gallery director Joe Cyril says,

> **ONE OF THE WORKS EMBLEMATIC OF THE SHOW IS 'STREET ART': GRAFFITI SCRIPT WITH MEN URINATING ON IT**

"Guesswho creates the artworks through stencil and enamel aerosol on metal or board and uses archival ways to create the patina or lime-washed backgrounds on the metal surface, emulating the surfaces of street walls."

Unlikely juxtapositions are evident, like the man sitting on his haunches with a signboard that's an irreverent hat-tip to the acclaimed, once-anonymous street artist Banksy. Or the sari-clad woman wielding a can of spray paint in 'She CAN'.

Stick No Bills is a two-part exhibition. You can see one half of the collection in Mumbai, while 13 other works will be shown in Kochi's Muziris Contemporary, bringing the narrative back to its coastal roots. ■

—Priya Pathiyan

The exhibition is on at Muziris Contemporary, Mumbai till Oct. 11 and at Muziris Contemporary, Kochi from Sept. 13 to Nov. 30